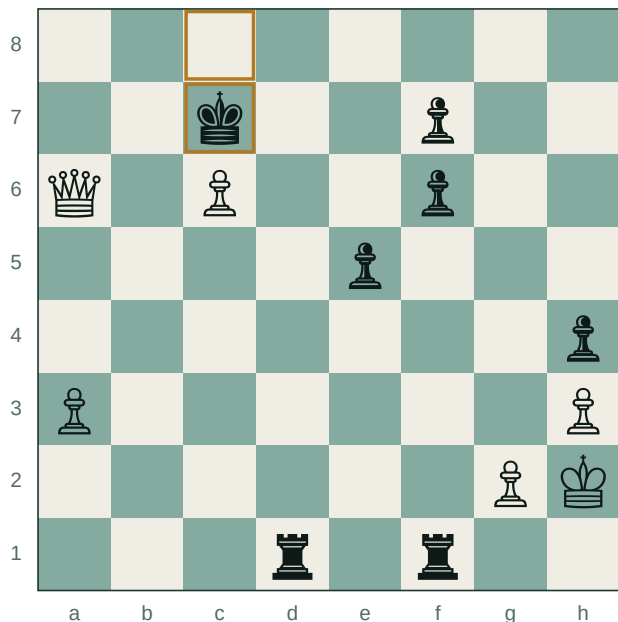


# Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 38

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 37...Kc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**38. Qb7+ Kd6 39. Qd7+ Kc5 40. Qxd1 Rxd1 41. c7 Rd6 42. c8=Q+**

**38.Qb7+** Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **38...Kd6**.

**39.Qd7+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **39...Kc5**.

**40.Qxd1** The queen captures the rook on d1. Recorded reply: **40...Rxd1**.

**41.c7** The pawn moves from c6 to c7. Recorded reply: **41...Rd6**.

**42.c8=Q+** Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on c7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.